Moby Dick (1956) | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Write brief answers. Use character choices and scene evidence for analysis.

Before viewing

1. What is the difference between commitment and obsession?

During viewing

2. Why does Ishmael seek a voyage?

3. How does Ishmael’s friendship with Queequeg challenge an initial assumption?

4. What does Father Mapple’s sermon add to the opening?

5. What goal does Ahab announce to the crew?

6. How does the promised reward encourage participation?

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During viewing

7. Why does Starbuck question Ahab’s purpose?

8. What happens when ordinary work competes with the pursuit?

9. How does Queequeg’s coffin change its function?

10. Why can Ishmael tell the story afterward?

After viewing

11. Choose a moment when Starbuck represents an alternative kind of leadership.

12. What is lost when a long novel becomes a shorter adventure film?

13. Why should the whale’s behavior not be treated as a scientific explanation?

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